

JSS 2 MATHEMATICS – FIRST TERM

TOPIC 6: DIRECTED AND NON-DIRECTED NUMBERS

1. Definitions

Directed numbers have both magnitude and direction (positive or negative). Examples: +5, -3, +2.5, -0.7. They are also called integers when whole, or more generally signed numbers.

Non-directed numbers have magnitude only (no sign). Examples: 5, 3, 2.5 (ordinary positive numbers as used in counting).

2. Number Line

Directed numbers are represented on a number line with zero in the middle, positive numbers to the right and negative numbers to the left.

3. Square and Square Root Tables

Square tables give the square of a number; square root tables give approximate square roots. Learn to look up values correctly (including for numbers not perfect squares).

4. Summary

Directed numbers have signs (+ or -) and show direction as well as size. The number line and tables of squares/square roots are useful tools.

End of Topic 6